PARKITECTURE

Take Me Out to the Booterpark

The Icer Air competition brings big air to the ballpark.

Baseball season is over, and in San Francisco's AT&T Park, the visage of hulking-yet-girly-voiced slugger Barry Bonds will soon give way to another bizarre sight: a tabletop jump…on steroids. The 100-foot-tall carcass hucker—built over deep center field—will be the centerpiece of the Icer Air 2006 competition, a big-air smackdown featuring pro skiers and riders hitting the booter, wakeboarders spinning 900s in McCovey Cove, and everyone's favorite MC, Jonny Moseley.

Last year's Icer Air event featured an 800-foot inrun that sent skiers sailing over the city's notoriously steep Fillmore Street and gave the term "urban jibbing" a whole new meaning. But when the contest moved to the home of the San Francisco Giants (which, like all baseball diamonds, is flat), Icer's engineers hit up X Games terrain-park guru Chris "Gunny" Gunnarson for advice.

To work within the tight stadium footprint, Gunnarson and his team are lifting the starting gate to JumboTron level and extending the landing all the way down to second base. Just before game day on November 4, they'll plaster the 350-foot-long, 100-foot-tall structure with 200 tons of snow being trucked in and made on-site. "The weather won't be ideal for working with snow, and pulling the whole thing off with scaffolding rather than on a hill is going to be tough," Gunnarson says. "But at the same time, it's those kinds of challenges that make it so cool."

The $10,000 in prize money at stake doesn't hurt either. That and a new car are apparently enough to draw big-league freeskiers like Tanner Hall, T.J. Schiller, and Simon Dumont. Look for them to hit speeds of 60 miles per hour before pop-flying 25 feet off the deck and 65 feet down the landing. All that, and not a dollop of the BALCO juice in sight! Damn, jibbing is wholesome. **—JEFF FOSS**

AS THE TRAM TURNS

Know how soap operas kill a character off only to have his "lost twin" appear the next season? Same deal with the new Jackson Hole Tram—sort of.

Jackson Hole officials finally have a plan to replace the Tram they wrote out of the script at the end of last season. The resort will install a 100-person, $25-million Doppelmayr tram by December 2008. It'll be like the old Tram (red; supported by cables) except way better: The new cable cars will ascend 4,139 feet in 9.5 minutes—three minutes quicker than the old 60-person cattle cars—and will follow the same classic route. In the meantime (and in young and restless skier years, two winters without the Tram is indeed *mean* time), skiers will access the summit of Rendezvous Mountain via a new chairlift that, though efficient, is in no way as cool as the Tram. **—RACHEL ODELL**

GRIFFIX THUNKIT/CLINT MILLER/ICERAIR.COM (TOP), COURTESY OF JACKSON HOLE MOUNTAIN RESORT

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